

Dillora by Kashvin

Project Context & Handoff Document

A living summary of the project, decisions, current state, and what's pending. Share this together with the project folder so a new session can continue exactly where we left off.

1. What this project is

Dillora by Kashvin is a handmade / made-to-order D2C store (India) selling phone covers, charms, crochet, resin art and oversize t-shirts. It is a single monorepo with three apps:

Backend/	Node.js + Express + MongoDB REST API. Runs on port 5000 .
Frontend/	Next.js 16 customer storefront. Port 3000 . This is the ACTIVE storefront.
dashboard/	Next.js 16 admin panel. Port 3001 .
dillora-frontend/	Empty legacy folder - ignore / safe to delete.

Live domain (intended): kashvin.in. Git: github.com/VandanaTripathi31/Dillora-Kashvin (branch: main). Note: there is now a second collaborator on the repo.

2. Tech stack

Backend	Express 5, Mongoose (MongoDB Atlas), JWT + bcrypt auth, Cloudinary (media), Razorpay (payments), ES modules. Reads config from Backend/.env.
Frontend + dashboard	Next.js 16 (App Router, Turbopack), React 19, Tailwind CSS 3.4 (preflight OFF), lucide-react icons.
Data flow	Fully backend-driven. The storefront has NO offline fallback - if the API is down, pages are empty. Seed the DB or the store is blank.

3. How to run it

```
npm --prefix Backend run dev      # API -> http://localhost:5000
npm --prefix Frontend run dev     # shop -> http://localhost:3000
npm --prefix dashboard run dev    # admin-> http://localhost:3001

npm --prefix Backend run seed     # seed 82 products, admin, coupons,
                                # videos, and 6 feedback testimonials
```

Admin login	admin@dillora.com / Dillora@2026 (default seeded - CHANGE before going live)
Env files	Backend/.env and Frontend/.env.local exist locally (gitignored). NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL points the storefront/dashboard at the API.
Razorpay	In TEST mode (rzp_test_ keys). Keys already in Backend/.env.

IMPORTANT dev gotcha: after editing a dashboard Tailwind config or CSS file, the Turbopack cache can go stale and silently stop generating new classes. Fix: `rm -rf dashboard/.next` then restart the dev server.

4. How the owner works & wants changes

Read this before making changes - it captures the owner's preferences:

- **Don't break existing functionality or remove features** - this is the #1 rule.
- **Keep the design/branding/colors identical** for the STOREFRONT unless a redesign is explicitly asked for. (The DASHBOARD was explicitly redesigned to a modern-SaaS look - full width, more spacing.)
- **Everything must be dynamic** (backend-driven) - no hardcoded data on the storefront.

- **Tailwind-first:** convert components to Tailwind utilities, but keep bespoke animations, shared primitives (.container/.grid/.btn/.card/.modal) and keyframes in a lean global stylesheet.
- Owner moves fast and wants execution, but appreciates being asked on genuine product decisions (e.g. moderation on/off, which OTP provider) rather than guessing.
- Verify changes live in the browser before calling them done.

5. What has been built so far (current state)

Area	Status
Razorpay payments	DONE - test mode; order-create + HMAC signature verify; checkout flow wired.
Pure-backend data	DONE - removed the localStorage/catalog offline fallback.
Tailwind migration - storefront	DONE - every page + component (hero/craft/catstrip kept as scoped CSS art).
Tailwind migration - dashboard	DONE - all 9 pages + layout + components.
Dashboard redesign	DONE - full-width (removed 1100px cap), modern cards, roomier tables, spacing.
Products multi-select delete	DONE - checkbox column + select-all + bulk-delete bar.
Dynamic feedback / testimonials	DONE - see section below.
Bug fixes	DONE - header hydration, order-confirmation lookup, CSS transforms, login centering.

Feedback feature (new):

- Backend: Feedback model + /api/feedback routes (public: submit / approved list / summary / can-submit; admin-protected: list-all / approve / delete). 6 testimonials seeded.
- Storefront Testimonials: dynamic cards with real per-card stars + a LIVE average rating, plus a 'Share your experience' form.
- Decisions locked: **admin-approved moderation** (submitted feedback is hidden until an admin approves it) and **signed-in customers only** (one feedback per customer; re-submitting re-queues for approval).
- Dashboard: a Feedback page (Pending / Approved / All + Approve / Hide / Delete) and a sidebar nav item.

6. Key architecture facts & gotchas

These cost real time to rediscover - keep them in mind:

- **Tailwind preflight is OFF** in both apps. That means Tailwind's --tw-translate/scale/rotate variable defaults are NOT injected, so every var-based transform (hover lifts, image zoom, mobile drawer slide) computes to 'none'. FIX already applied: a *, ::before, ::after { --tw-...: 0 } rule was added to both index.css files. Don't remove it.
- **Turbopack cache staleness** - see the dev gotcha above (rm -rf .next after config/CSS edits).
- **Arbitrary text sizes** like text-[1.4rem] sometimes fail to generate; prefer standard classes (text-2xl, etc.) for critical elements.
- **dotenv/ESM load order:** server.js uses import 'dotenv/config' so env is loaded before other imports. Provider configs (Razorpay) also read env lazily inside functions.
- **Order IDs are sequential:** DIL-1043 + order-count (Backend/services/idService.js). They are guessable and have a tiny collision risk - flagged for a future switch to random unguessable IDs.
- **Order lookup by phone is open** (GET /orders/by-phone/:phone). Minor privacy point at low scale; candidates: require order-ID + phone, and/or randomize order IDs.

7. Pending / next up (open threads)

OTP / phone verification (decision in progress):

- Today the /account 'login' is just name + phone with NO verification (demo).

- Discussed WhatsApp OTP vs Firebase Phone Auth vs SMS. Costs (India): SMS ~Rs 0.11-0.45/msg (needs DLT registration ~Rs 12k one-time), WhatsApp ~Rs 0.11-0.15/msg (Meta business verification), Firebase ~Rs 0.85 but first 10 SMS/day free and no paperwork.
- **Recommendation for low scale (agreed direction): do NOT deploy WhatsApp OTP yet.** It is a scale-up move. For now, close the order-lookup gap (order-ID + phone + randomize IDs); if real verification is wanted, Firebase Phone Auth is the low-effort choice. Full WhatsApp Cloud API setup steps were documented in chat.

Smaller proposed-but-not-done items:

- Randomize order IDs with `crypto.randomInt` (unguessable, no collision, no order-count leak).
- A 'change admin password' flow (script or dashboard Settings) - seeder won't update an existing admin.
- SMS fallback for OTP (only relevant once OTP is added).
- Dynamic sitemap (currently still generated from the static catalog file).
- Dashboard 'Users' page (placeholder, future-ready).

8. Git & collaboration

Remote	github.com/VandanaTripathi31/Dillora-Kashvin - branch main
Latest commit	f359fd4 (merge of the migration/redesign/feedback work with a collaborator's 'cloudinary fixed' commit)
Heads up	There is a collaborator pushing to main. Always git pull before starting work and before pushing to avoid rejected pushes / merge conflicts.

Generated as a handoff aid. When resuming: share this PDF + the project folder, say what you want to work on next, and we continue from here.